

WORKING DRAFT

ClassE US language guide

Prepared by Christopher Habetler with EdTech Expertz, for Matt Campbell, Joe Gelb and the ClassE team.

PURPOSE

A check against language that can sound outdated, controversial or unintentionally offensive to US educators.

STATUS

Current working draft as of September 29, 2026.
This will keep changing. Review anything in it before using it.

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About this guide

This guide proposes specific language for talking about students, teachers and ClassE with US educators. It is a check against words that can sound outdated, controversial or unintentionally offensive to a US ear, with a better option for each.

US buyers are skeptical of edtech, and many have been burned before, so they listen for signals, good or bad. A district that buys ClassE is saying, “This is the best place to spend public funds for our kids.”

Most of the examples come from real calls, including some of Christopher’s. They work in Israel. A US buyer hears them differently, so the idea stays and the words change. Where the guide suggests wording, it is one option, and the team may choose a different one.

The quick frame

SHARED BELIEFS

This language is based on core beliefs that are widely shared in US schools.

Every child can, and will, grow.

Every child can make radical growth in the right conditions. The job is to help build those conditions.

Kids do well if they can.

This is an idea from Ross Greene, a US psychologist. A student who is struggling is missing a skill, not the will. When a student has a learning gap, it means the right way has not been found yet. Never, ever because the kid does not want to.

Never blame students or families.

Nothing we say can be heard as blaming kids or not believing in them. Families are partners.

Every student is an individual.

Never generalize about a child from a group or from one story. A student’s culture, language and community are strengths the student brings.

PHRASES WE HAVE HEARD FROM YOU

From the September workshop. These already carry the beliefs above.

“Bring the student up to the question, rather than bringing the question down to the student.”

School teams will always be able to modify and accommodate a student’s work.

“Teacher in the loop.”

“Partnership with teachers.”

“Albert is a feature of ClassE, not ClassE itself.”

Language agreements so far

- “Practice” for what students do in ClassE.
- “Progress toward mastery,” not “mastered” or “achieved mastery.”
- “Targeted practice” and “targeted support,” not “remediation.”
- “A student with a disability,” naming the student first.
- “English learner,” or the district’s own term.
- Albert is one feature of ClassE.

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The short list of language to get right

✗ WHAT WAS SAID	✓ TRY INSTEAD	WHAT WENT WRONG
“Closing the gaps with the weakest students.”	“Seven students missed this skill. The teacher can teach them in a small group.”	It ranks children by level.
“These parents are working two jobs. They just don’t have time.”	“What does support at home look like in your community?”	It guesses about families as a group.
“Your ESL students.”	“Your English learners,” or the district’s term, such as “emergent bilingual” in Texas.	It is out of date. ESL is a program, not a name for a child.
“The platform is teacher-proof.”	“The teacher leads. ClassE supports.”	It says the teacher is the problem.
“80% of the class got that question right, so 80% has achieved mastery in that standard.”	“80% of the class got that question right.” Over several weeks: “progress toward mastery.”	Mastery is a state test label, and one question cannot carry it.
“We can do 10 exercises and diagnose exactly what the problem is.”	“The student got these questions wrong on this skill. This is where to focus next.”	“Diagnose” sounds like a disability evaluation, which only the district runs, with the parent’s consent.

✗ WHAT WAS SAID	✓ TRY INSTEAD	WHAT WENT WRONG
"An equity engine that dismantles traditional testing and builds belonging."	Say what ClassE does for each student, and follow the buyer's lead on equity language.	It takes a political side the buyer did not ask about.
"Thousands of kids that use ClassE in Israel have better grades."	"Schools in Israel use it. We don't have a controlled study of its effect on grades yet."	It claims a result nobody has measured, and a US buyer will ask how we know.
"An exercise platform."	"Practice."	It sounds translated, and a little like a fitness app.

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Check locally

There are regional and district-level differences. A few things to check before a call:

- How does the district or state refer to students learning English?
- How does it refer to students with disabilities, and to its tiers of extra help?
- What does it call its standards and its state test?
- What are its policies on student use of AI? That decides how much Albert becomes a selling point.

Texas and New York, side by side

The same word can be safe in one state and risky in the other. The laws and policies here were checked in September 2026.

	Texas	New York and the Northeast
Law and policy	SB 12, a Texas law limiting DEI work in K-12 schools, in effect since September 1, 2025. A federal court has blocked parts of it in some districts while the case continues.	The Culturally Responsive-Sustaining Education Framework, New York State guidance since 2019.
Equity words	Do not raise equity, DEI or identity words. If the district uses one, follow its lead.	Many schools use equity, identity and asset framing words. Follow the buyer's lead. Using a buyer's own words is not the same as raising DEI.
How to open	"ClassE gives students practice on your curriculum and your standards, once we set it up with you." Say "TEKS" only after the team confirms the alignment.	The same sentence.

State test	STAAR. A 2025 law, HB 8, replaces it with new tests starting in 2027-28. Use the name the district uses. Its top level is “Masters Grade Level,” so Texas educators say “masters” as an official label. Never use “mastery” for a ClassE result.	The New York State tests.
English learners	“Emergent bilingual” for the student. “ESL” or “bilingual” for the program.	“English Language Learners (ELLs),” the New York State term. New York also uses “Multilingual Learners (MLs)” for a wider group.

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Commonly asked questions

Questions buyers ask where a quick answer can clear up a misconception.

“So you’re like i-Ready?”

“Some parts are similar. Let’s show you what happens after a student misses a question.”

“Can we use this for progress monitoring?”

Progress monitoring is the district’s process, tied to IEP goals and tiered support. Say what ClassE shows: “which questions each student got right and wrong, on which skill, this week.”

“What about English learners, students with IEPs and advanced students?”

These are three separate questions. Ask: “What supports does your district already use for each?”

“What does the AI do?”

Say what the student sees: “The student gets a second question on the same skill.” Do not say the AI explains or teaches.

“Is it evidence-based?”

“We don’t have a controlled study on that yet. Here’s what we can show you.” No product is ESSA certified.

“We already pay for another product.”

Do not offer to replace it. Ask: “What do your teachers use it for today?”

Word list, A to Z

Look up a word before using it. Each suggestion is one option, not the only one.

✗ WORD OR PHRASE	✓ TRY INSTEAD	WHY
“Acceleration,” for ClassE	“Targeted practice.” Use “acceleration” only for the district’s own program.	In Texas it is a program set in law, with minimum hours and tutor ratios.
“Accommodate” and “modify,” mixed up	“Accommodation” when the student reaches the same work another way. “Modification” when the work itself changes.	In US special education they are different decisions, and the student’s IEP or 504 team makes them. Mixing them up signals not knowing the system.
“ADHD students,” “cognitive issues,” “students with different diagnosed learning disabilities”	“A student with a disability,” or what the student needs.	A student’s disability category is private.
AI hype: “a revolution in education,” “30 personalized tutors that know your students”	Describe what the AI does. “Albert, the AI tutor, asks the student questions, so the student works it out.”	No one can check it.
“Any curriculum”	“We set it up with your curriculum.”	Check with the product team before promising it to a specific district.
“At risk,” “low performing,” about a student	“Students who have not shown this skill yet.”	In Texas, at risk is a legal category. Low performing is a federal term for schools.
“Bring the students to the test,” “the exact model of what they’re going to see on that test”	“Help the student up to the question.” “We build the practice on your curriculum and your standards.”	It sounds like teaching to the test.
“Competency issues,” “needs help,” “competent,” about a student	“This student missed these three questions.”	It labels the child. Describe the answers.
“Data-driven”	“Data-informed.”	It sounds like the numbers make the decisions.
“Depends a lot on the quality of the teachers”	Do not raise it.	It judges the buyer’s staff.
“Diagnose” about a child: “diagnose exactly what the problem is”	“ClassE shows which students missed which standard, down to the question.”	“Diagnose” sounds like a doctor. In a US school, only an evaluation, with the parent’s consent, decides whether a student has a disability.
“Diagnostic,” “assessment platform,” “diagnostic and remediation tool,” as the name for ClassE	Describe what ClassE does. “Diagnostic” is fine later, about skills and standards.	The first label decides what the buyer compares ClassE to. Buyers who heard “diagnostic” first said, “Oh, so you’re i-Ready.”
“Drill and kill,” or any other product, run down	Describe what ClassE does.	The district may use that product.
Equity, DEI, “culturally responsive”	Follow the buyer’s lead. Never use them for ClassE.	In Texas, state law limits DEI work. In either state, never describe ClassE as doing equity work itself.

 WORD OR PHRASE	 TRY INSTEAD	WHY
“ESL students,” “LEP”	“English learner” or “multilingual learner.” In Texas, “emergent bilingual.”	ESL is a program, not a name for a child. Federal law replaced LEP.
“Exactly where the student’s reasoning is breaking down”	“Here are the questions the student got wrong on this skill.”	It claims to see inside the student’s head.
“An exercise platform,” “marks”	“Practice,” “practice questions,” “scores.”	“An exercise platform” can sound like a fitness app to a US ear. “Marks” is British usage.
Guessing about families: “these parents are working two jobs, they just don’t have time”	“What does support at home look like in your community?”	It guesses about families as a group.
“I don’t see color”	Do not raise race.	Today it can sound like not seeing the student.
“Intervention,” “intervention platform,” as the name for ClassE	Say what each part does: the teacher gets what they need to intervene, and Albert gives each student targeted support.	On its own, “intervention” tells a US buyer ClassE is a formal Tier 2 or Tier 3 program, and they will ask for that evidence.
“Mastered,” “proficient,” “masters of this skill,” for a ClassE result	“A correct response.” Over time: “progress toward mastery.”	These are state test labels. One question cannot carry them.
“Meets FERPA,” “meets WCAG,” or any standard	“I’ll find out and get back to you.”	Not until the product team confirms it. Buyers worry about student data inside an AI system.
“Neurodivergent student,” as the general term	What the student needs.	It is a word some people use about themselves. Follow the family’s lead.
One student’s story as proof	“That’s one student’s result. It’s not proof yet.”	One story is not evidence, and it generalizes from one child.
“Progress monitoring,” for ClassE	Describe the evidence in plain words.	It is the district’s process, tied to IEP goals and tiered support.
“Proven,” “evidence-based,” “ESSA certified”	“We don’t have a controlled study on that yet. Here’s what we can show you.” “Evidence-informed design.”	ESSA tiers rate the evidence behind a program. The federal government does not certify products.
“Remediation,” for ClassE	“Targeted practice.” Use “remediation” if the district says it first.	It is the district’s word to choose.
“The same difficulty,” for the second question	“A second question on the same skill.”	No field-test data or item statistics show it yet.
“Saves a lot of time for teachers”	“No more hours of grading and spreadsheets.”	Name the work that goes away. A principal who hears “saves time” can hear that the teacher will have less to do.
“Special needs kids,” “SPED student,” “special accommodations”	“A student with a disability.” For ClassE features: “accessibility supports,” once confirmed for the US.	Name the student first. Accessibility is not special education.
“Teacher-proof,” “make them better teachers,” “faster than teachers”	“The teacher leads. ClassE supports.” “ClassE shows the teacher sooner which students missed which skill.”	In a US school it says the vendor thinks the teacher is the problem.
“These kids”	“Let’s look at what each student did.”	It turns individual students into a group.
Tiers: “a Tier 1 type of remediation,” “your Tier 3 kids,” “tier to tier” for scores	Tiers only for what the district runs. For scores: “score band,” “performance level.”	Tiers are the district’s system, never a name for ClassE or a student.
“Upload an IEP”	Do not offer it.	An IEP is a confidential student record.

✗ WORD OR PHRASE	✓ TRY INSTEAD	WHY
Usage as a result: how many students or schools use it	“Here is what students got right and wrong, on which skills.”	Usage is not a result.
“Weak students,” “strong students,” “a GAP student,” “a pretty good student”	“Each student gets practice on the skill they missed.”	It ranks children. Praise is still a judgment.

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Open questions

- **“Diagnostic” and “intervention.”** The guide suggests not calling ClassE “diagnostic” or “an intervention.” To a US buyer, “diagnostic” can sound like a disability evaluation, and “intervention” like a formal Tier 2 or Tier 3 program. Is everyone comfortable moving away from both as names for ClassE?
- **“Mastery” in the product.** Teachers still see “mastery” in ClassE, including off a single question. The recommendation is to change it to “progress toward mastery,” the language in this guide. Can the product make that change?

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US terms and sources

504 plan A plan under Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act for a student with a disability who needs accommodations.	ENL English as a New Language, the New York program name.	ESSA Every Student Succeeds Act, which sets the evidence tiers.	FERPA Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act, on student records.
IDEA Individuals with Disabilities Education Act, the special education law.	IEP Individualized Education Program.	MTSS Multi-Tiered System of Supports.	STAAR The Texas state test.
TEKS Texas Essential Knowledge and Skills, the Texas standards.	WCAG Web Content Accessibility Guidelines.		

Sources

Sources, with laws and legal terms checked in September 2026: at risk, Texas Education Code 29.081. Emergent bilingual, Texas Education Code 29.052. Acceleration, Texas HB 4545 and HB 1416. LEP, replaced by “English learner” in ESSA (2015). SB 12, in effect September 1, 2025, with parts blocked by a federal court in some districts while the case continues. STAAR, replaced by new tests starting in 2027-28 under Texas HB 8 (2025). New York student data, Education Law 2-d requires a data privacy agreement when a vendor receives student data. Neurodivergent, not one of the 13 IDEA disability categories. Kids do well if they can, Ross Greene.